

April

13

2019

Stratolaunch

Originally designed as a flying launchpad for rockets, Stratolaunch – the world's largest aircraft by wingspan – flew for the first time, over the Mojave Desert in California, USA. The distance between its wingtips is longer than a football pitch.



1953

The name's Bond

British writer Ian Fleming's *Casino Royale* introduced the fictional British secret service agent James Bond. It was the first book in a series of 12 action-packed spy novels that were later turned into blockbuster movies.



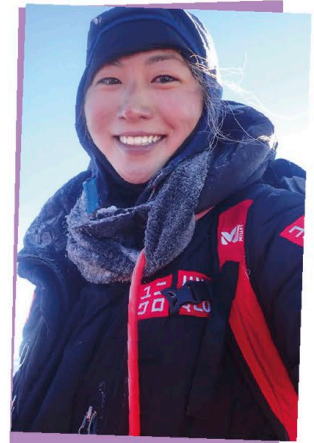
Born this day

1519 Catherine de' Medici, Italian noblewoman. She married King Henry II of France and had a powerful role in French politics as the mother of three future kings.

2017

The ultimate challenge

Having already climbed the world's seven highest mountains and skied to the South Pole, 20-year-old Japanese adventurer Marin Minamiya became the youngest person to complete the Explorer's Grand Slam when she reached the North Pole.



Also on this day

1204 Though tasked with recapturing **Jerusalem**, a western Christian army instead sacked the Byzantine city of Constantinople and stole its treasures.

1964 Bahamian-American actor **Sidney Poitier** became the **first Black person** to win the Best Actor Oscar, for the film *Lilies of the Field*.

1997 In a **major golfing win**, US golfer Tiger Woods became the youngest winner of the Masters Tournament at the age of 21.